SUNDAY 26 APRIL 2026
Fourth Sunday of Easter
Good Shepherd Sunday

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

PRIESTS:
REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393
Parish websites *(including access to church webcams)* and emails:
Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com **Email:** aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org
Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com **Email:** drumquin@derrydiocese.org
Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com **Email:** castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:
Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR TH5IS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday *27 April*		**Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm**	**Mass, 10.00am** **Rosary, 8.00pm at Our Lady's Grotto**
Tuesday *28 April*	**Mass, 10.00am**		**Rosary, 10.00am**
Wednesday *29 April*	**Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion, 10.00am**	**Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion, 10.00am**	**Mass, 10.00am**
Thursday *30 April*	**Mass, 10.00am, with Adoration until 12.00noon**		
Friday *1 May*	**Mass, 7.30pm** *(AranDerg CCE)*	**Mass, 10.00am, with Adoration until 12.00noon**	
Saturday *2 May*	**Vigil Mass, 7.30pm:**	**Vigil Mass, Castlederg: 6.15pm**	**Vigil Mass: 5.00pm**
Sunday *3 May*	**Mass: 11.00am:** *First Anniversary - John Gallen* *(Mass on 1st, 3rd & 5th Sunday)*	**Mass: Dregish, 9.30am** **Drumnabey,12.30pm** **Castlederg:** *(Mass on 2nd, 4th & 5th Sunday)*	**Mass: 11.00am** *(Mass on 1st, 3rd & 5th Sunday)*

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,012 & €25. **Church Restoration Fund** £762 & €11. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,096.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,069 & €156, made up of:
Castlederg £1,350 & €142, **Drumnabey** £420 & €12, **Dregish** £299 & €2.

Thank you also for donations as follows, in Castlederg:
£100 for Confirmation flowers for church; £300 from the Legion of Mary towards heat and light

Sincere thanks, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In March, these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £850 & €20; Restoration Fund £627; Ardstraw West & Castlederg £2,049; Drumquin £2,350.

PIONEER meeting will take place this Wednesday, 29 April, at 7.30pm in Drumquin Parochial House.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Paddy Gallagher and Finola Scott, whose Funeral Masses took place in Drumquin last week. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: Today is the last of the second year of the draw. It takes place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, after 9.30am Mass. Good luck to everyone.
We are most grateful to all who have participated in the draw. We are indebted to our faithful promoters and to those who carry out the admin work, which is essential to the smooth running of the draw. A huge thanks to one and all. The draw is a massive contributor to the cost of our parish development projects.
We look forward to the third year of the draw, which will commence on Sunday 31 May in Castlederg. If you pay monthly and are joining in the draw in the coming year, why not consider paying by Standing Order, if you do not already do so? Ask your promoter for details.
This year again we will have 1,200 tickets maximum. If there is anyone who is not currently in the draw but would like to join it, please speak to one of our promoters or contact the parish office. In the event of there being no free numbers available, you will be placed on a waiting list, on a 'first come first served' basis. Thank you.

DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK SHRINE will take place on Saturday 6 June. In conjunction with the All-Ireland Rosary Rally, the pilgrimage will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Marian Shrine.

CELEBRATING THE FRIENDS OF ARANDERG CCÉ: Mass will be celebrated this Friday, 1 May, in St Patrick's Church, Aghyaran, at 7.30pm, followed by refreshments in Killeter Heritage Centre and an Irish Traditional Music Session. Everyone is welcome to come along to this special celebration in the church and in the Heritage Centre.

GEMMA McHALE CYCLE from Aghyaran Centre will take place on Sunday 3 May, commencing at 10.00am sharp. Registration from 9.00am. 35 miles/56k. Spot-prizes on the day.

CONRADH NA GAEILGE, Craobh na Deirge: Míle buíochas as gach duine a thug airgead ar son scolaireachtaí ar Lá Fhéile Pádraig. Thanks for all the generous donations to our collection on St Patrick's Day. Má tá duine ar bith ag iarraidh deontais Gaeltachta,déan teagmháil le Maolíosa, Treasa no Gráinne. Tá neart cúrsaí ar fáil do dhaoine fásta fosta. Go rai,bh maith agaibh. For any Gaeltacht scholarships, please contact Maolíosa, Treasa or Gráinne. Don't forget there are also many courses available for adults and not just secondary school students.

BLUEBELL PAINTING WORKSHOP: This event will take place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Wednesday 6 May, from 2.30 – 5.00pm. A free, guided painting workshop, with all materials supplied, and a bluebell walk. To book a place, please contact Claire on 07818 091 136. *The event is supported by the Peaceplus programme, HARC project, to whom we are most grateful.*

SACRAMENT OF CONFIRMATION:

Congratulations and Well Done to the boys and girls who received the Sacrament of Confirmation in Aghyaran on Saturday. It was a lovely celebration. We pray that the gifts and fruits of the Holy Spirit will be with you always, guiding you in faith, hope and love each day. Thank you to the teacher and supporting staff in the school, and to the parents and family members who helped the children prepare so well for their Confirmation Day. Thank you to all who came along to support the children on this special day in their faith journey. Special thanks to the choir for the beautiful singing and hymns, which enhanced the liturgy so much.
Please keep in your prayer the children of our parishes who are preparing to receive the Sacrament of Confirmation. The Drumquin Confirmation will take place on Saturday 16 May, at 11.00am.

This Fourth Sunday of Easter is known as Good Shepherd Sunday, a special day of prayer for Vocations to priesthood and Religious life. The image of the Good Shepherd – and of the search for the lost sheep – appears in various ways throughout the Gospels. Shepherds were among the first to hear of the birth of Jesus, and He is later revealed as the Lamb of God who takes away the sins of the world. Jesus, the Good Shepherd, reminds us that the Lord is not distant, but walks with us, guiding, protecting and calling each by name. As we mark World Day of Prayer for Vocations, we ask God for the grace to listen more closely for His voice in our lives, trusting that His call – whatever it may be – leads us to fullness of life and love.
We remember in a special way the men in our diocese who are currently studying for priesthood, that the Good Shepherd will guide them in their vocation.